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2.2.3.4 Spacing Text

Reading text on a Word document should be stress-free and easy on the eyes. You may have come across documents in which the author has paid no attention to arranging the text, and has made a mess of the document. Users will easily tire reading documents that do not contain orderly text spacing and are arranged in a jumbled manner. Here are tips to avoid being a member of this tribe!

2.2.3.4.1 Indents

Indents are meant to align the text on the page properly. You can use the default indent spacing that Word sets by default, but you may have to change these settings on some occasions. You can set indents in various ways for different text, the most common of them being the paragraph indent. This indent lets a reader know where a paragraph ends, and where the next one begins. Here's what you need to do.

1. Select the text for which you want to change the indent.
2. Click on 'Format-Paragraph' in the menu bar.
3. Then click on the drop-down arrow beside 'Special' and choose whether you want the paragraph style to be first-line or hanging. Choosing first line indent will automatically create a 1.5 inch space on the first line of every paragraph. This is the general style when writing business documents.

You can also manually make changes to the indent size by dragging the indent markers on the ruler on the top of the page to the left or right depending on how you want to place the text.

In the 'Paragraph' dialog box, you will notice that under the heading 'Indentation' there is options for 'Left' and 'Right'. Changing the values in these boxes will affect the left and right